

RUBICON WORKFLOWS

Brand Guidelines

Automate the routine, focus on the results.

Version 0.1

Logo mark added. See Section 8.

Prepared for partner designers and brand collaborators.

This document captures every locked brand decision to date. Treat it as the source of truth for any creative or written work produced for Rubicon Workflows.

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1. Brand essence

Company name

Rubicon Workflows

Always use the full two-word name in any public, searchable, or first-time context. “Rubicon” alone is acceptable only in established conversations or internal use — several larger companies share the “Rubicon” name, so we protect search visibility by leading with the full name everywhere it matters.

Tagline

Automate the routine, focus on the results.

Used adjacent to the logo, in email signatures, and in any context where a short brand expression is needed.

One-liner

We find the parts of your operation that are eating your team’s time, and we automate them to increase accuracy and free people up for the work that actually matters — without replacing your systems or overhauling how you work.

This is the standard answer to “so what do you do?” — used in introductions, profile bios, networking, and any time the full elevator pitch is too long.

Elevator pitch

You know how every business has tasks that just eat hours — the weekly reports, the data entry, the back-and-forth between systems? At Rubicon Workflows, we find those parts of your operation and automate them, so your team can focus on the work that actually matters. We work inside whatever systems you already use, starting with one bottleneck and building from there. The name’s intentional — once you cross the Rubicon on a workflow, you don’t go back to doing it the old way.

The four pillars

Everything we say, sell, and build comes back to these four ideas:

- **Operational efficiency** — Smoother operations, real cost savings.
- **Error reduction** — Fewer mistakes through code-based consistency or human-in-the-loop validation.
- **Incremental and embedded** — We work within your existing infrastructure, starting with one step and compounding wins from there. No rip-and-replace, no platform lock-in.
- **Augmentation, not replacement** — We automate the tedious parts so people can focus on the work they actually care about.

Personality

The brand is a deliberate blend of three modes:

- Precise and technically credible (engineering rigor)
- Approachable and pragmatic (trusted advisor, easy to work with)
- Creative problem-solvers (we find the real pain, not the obvious one)

We are NOT: flashy tech-startup, sleepy professional services firm, enterprise software vendor.

2. Target and positioning

Who we serve

Small-to-mid-sized businesses (roughly 15–200 people) where the workflow we’re automating impacts a team, not just an individual. Scale of impact matters more than size of company. A 15-person company where 10 people share the same workflow is a strong fit. A 200-person company where one person has a niche problem isn’t.

Decision maker

Almost always the owner, founder, or CEO. Operations managers sometimes initiate conversations, but final approval defaults to the owner. Our communication should be written for owner-operators — not procurement departments. That means plain language, business outcomes over technical specs, and a tone of “I get what it’s like to run this thing.”

Competitive landscape

No direct competitors yet. We’re educating a market, not fighting for share. The real “alternatives” clients consider are:

- Doing nothing — sticking with the manual process
- Cobbling together SaaS tools (Monday, Asana, Salesforce, etc.)
- Living with legacy custom software that can’t talk to anything modern

This shapes our marketing posture: less “why us vs them,” more “here’s what’s possible, here’s how we think about it.” We are a teaching brand, not a competitive one.

Positioning statement

For owner-led businesses with established operations, Rubicon Workflows is the automation partner that solves real bottlenecks one step at a time — because compounding small wins beats reinventing the system.

3. Voice and tone

Voice is the personality — it stays constant. Tone is how that personality adjusts to context: more formal in a proposal, warmer in a follow-up email, sharper in a LinkedIn post.

Voice traits

1. Plainspoken, not corporate.

We talk like business owners, not enterprise software vendors. No “leverage synergies,” no “robust solutions,” no “workflow orchestration platforms.” If you wouldn’t say it out loud to a friend over coffee, don’t write it.

2. Confident without being cocky.

We’ve done this work. We know what we’re doing. But we don’t oversell or overpromise — especially because most automation gets oversold. We say what we’ll do, then do it.

3. Educational, not salesy.

Our market often doesn’t fully understand what automation is or isn’t. Our job is to help them see what’s possible, not pressure them into buying. We explain, we show examples, we let the work speak.

4. Specific over generic.

“We saved a roadworks estimator about 6 hours a week comparing quote PDFs” beats “we deliver significant time savings.” Concrete numbers and real examples always.

5. Warm but professional.

We’re a small, owner-led shop. Clients should feel like they’re working with people who care, not a faceless agency. But we’re also not their friends — we’re their trusted advisors.

Tone shifts by context

Context	Tone
Cold outreach email	Direct, curious, low-pressure
Proposal / SOW	Confident, specific, professional
Project update	Plainspoken, transparent, no hiding bad news
LinkedIn post	Insightful, conversational, slight personality
Invoice / contract	Crisp, clear, no fluff

On AI specifically

We use AI when it’s the right tool, not because it’s a selling point. Many of our automations use deterministic code, API integrations, or scripted logic — which are often better than AI because they’re predictable and don’t hallucinate. When we do use AI, we say so plainly. When we don’t, we don’t pretend we do.

USE: “uses AI” only when it literally does. Be specific: “uses an LLM to summarize the document,” “uses AI to extract structured data from PDFs.”

AVOID: “AI-powered,” “AI-driven,” “intelligent automation” as marketing terms.

Words

USE	AVOID
automate, workflow, bottleneck, manual, custom, fit, step, accuracy, time, find, build, work, partner	leverage, synergize, robust, solution-oriented, holistic, enterprise-grade, AI-powered (unless literal), seamless, revolutionary, disrupt

4. Typography

Typefaces

Space Grotesk — Primary brand typeface

- Used for: All display, headings, body, captions, navigation
- Weights used: 400 (regular), 500 (medium)
- Source: Google Fonts / Fontsource (free, open-source)

Why this typeface: Space Grotesk has slightly unconventional letterforms that give it real character without sacrificing readability. It signals “someone designed this thoughtfully” rather than “we used the default,” and it’s not yet overexposed the way Inter or Helvetica are.

JetBrains Mono — Accent typeface

- Used for: Eyebrow labels, section markers, inline code/technical references, the brand-signature tilde prefix
- Weights used: 400 (regular)
- Source: Google Fonts / Fontsource (free, open-source)

Why this pairing: JetBrains Mono provides the “technical with personality” edge. It carries real engineering credibility and pairs cleanly with Space Grotesk. Used sparingly so it stays special.

Type hierarchy

Tier	Size / LH	Font	Weight / Tracking	Use for
Display XL	56 / 60	Space Grotesk	500 / - 0.025em	Website hero, deck cover

Tier	Size / LH	Font	Weight / Tracking	Use for
Display L	40 / 46	Space Grotesk	500 / - 0.02em	Section openers, proposal covers
H1	32 / 38	Space Grotesk	500 / - 0.015em	Page titles
H2	24 / 30	Space Grotesk	500 / - 0.01em	Major section breaks
H3	18 / 26	Space Grotesk	500 / - 0.005em	Sub-sections
Body L	18 / 30	Space Grotesk	400	Marketing copy on website
Body M	16 / 26	Space Grotesk	400	Default body — proposals, blog, documents
Body S	14 / 22	Space Grotesk	400	Secondary info, captions, footnotes
Eyebrow	11 / 16	JB Mono	400 / 0.1em uppercase	Kicker labels above sections, in sage
Inline mono	13 / 22	JB Mono	400	Code, filenames, technical strings
Caption	12 / 18	Space Grotesk	400	Photo captions, fine print, metadata

Display treatment: hanging mono index

Display moments use a distinctive pattern: each line of display text is prefixed with a mono “01 /” marker hanging in the left margin. This reinforces the brand’s incremental philosophy visually and creates a signature look.

Example:

01 / **Automate the routine.**

02 / **Focus on the results.**

Specifications:

- Mono marker: JetBrains Mono 400, ~30% of display size, in Sage (#7DA371)
- Marker hangs to the left of the display text (negative margin / outdent)
- Marker spacing: roughly 64px before display text in default lockup

- For displays without a clear numbered structure, use the Display tier from the hierarchy without the mono marker

Mono usage rules

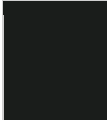
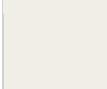
JetBrains Mono is the brand’s flavor. Used sparingly so it stays special. Appears in three specific contexts only:

- **Eyebrow labels** — uppercase, small, tracked out, sage colored, used as a kicker above section titles (e.g. “~ OUR APPROACH”)
- **Inline mono** — filenames, code snippets, technical specs, command-line strings, anywhere actual code or syntax appears
- **Brand-signature tilde** — the “~” prefix appears in eyebrow labels and as a small visual flourish in footers, dividers, and decorative moments. Hints at command-line aesthetics. Use sparingly.

5. Color palette

A six-color palette with clear roles. Each color has a job; colors are not interchangeable. The system supports light, warm, dark, and brand-signature surface modes — see deployment rules below.

The six colors

	Name	Hex	Role
	Forest	#2E4B3C	Hero brand color. Primary accent on light surfaces. Also used as a brand-signature surface itself.
	Sage	#7DA371	Accent on dark surfaces. Used for eyebrow labels, mono accents, secondary CTAs, icons. Lighter green for moments where Forest gets lost.
	Pine	#1A1D1B	Dark surface background. Also primary text color on light surfaces. Not pure black — a soft, slightly green-tinted near-black.
	Slate	#6B6F62	Muted text. Used for secondary info, captions, footnotes, dividers, and less important UI elements.
	Honey	#B89B6E	Small accent role. Used for mono details on dark surfaces, special badges, and subtle warmth. Never the primary CTA color.
	Bone	#F0EEE7	Light surface background. Also light text on dark surfaces. Warm off-white, not pure white.

Surface deployment rules

The brand has multiple surface modes. Each surface has a job. Choose surface based on what the moment needs to do:

Dark surface (Pine) = impact, mood, attention

Used when you want someone to feel something. Website hero, marketing pages, business card fronts, social graphics, deck covers. Dark surfaces signal “this is important, pay attention.” On dark, Sage leads as the accent color (Forest disappears against Pine), and Honey appears in mono details.

Light surface (Bone) = content, readability, work

Used when someone needs to actually read or process information. Proposals, invoices, blog posts, case study bodies, FAQ pages, email signatures. Light surfaces are functional — they get out of the way so the content does its job. On light, Forest leads as the accent.

Forest surface = brand signature

Used sparingly for “this is unmistakably us” moments. About page hero, the back of a pitch deck cover, a section divider on the website. Used too much it becomes wallpaper; used selectively, it becomes a signature.

Touchpoint deployment

Rubicon Workflows is a dark-led brand. The website is roughly 60–70% dark with strategic light sections. Documents lean light. Physical and social touchpoints lean dark.

Touchpoint	Surface	Why
Website hero	Dark	First impression, high impact
Website “Our work” section	Dark	Case study cards on a moody canvas
Case study detail page	Light	People are reading — functional surface
Blog / content articles	Light	Long-form reading needs light
Proposal cover	Forest	Signature moment — “this is us”
Proposal body pages	Light	Functional, gets printed
Invoice	Light	Standard expectation, prints cleanly
Business card front	Dark	Logo on moody surface = memorable
Business card back	Light	Contact info — functional
Email signature	Light	Emails are universally light
LinkedIn graphics	Dark	Bold + thumb-stopping in a feed

6. Iconography

Style: mixed weight rounded

Icons follow a single consistent style across the brand. Inconsistent iconography is one of the most under-thought parts of brand systems; we pick one approach and stick to it.

Specifications

- **Outer shapes / containers:** 2px stroke, sage (#7DA371)
- **Inner details:** 1.5px stroke, sage (#7DA371) — subtle weight hierarchy within each icon
- **Caps:** all round
- **Joins:** all round
- **Fills:** none (except feature variant, see below)

Feature variant (in container)

For prominent icon usage (feature cards, hero sections, high-emphasis moments), icons may sit inside a rounded square container:

- Container: rounded square, 10px corner radius
- Container fill: Sage at ~13% opacity (rgba(125, 163, 113, 0.13))
- Container border: none
- Icon inside maintains the standard mixed-weight spec

Color guidance

Icons are sage (#7DA371) by default. Honey, Forest, or Bone may be used for specific contexts (e.g. status indicators), but not the default. Never mix icon colors in a single icon — one icon, one color.

7. Naming and digital

Company name spelling

Rubicon Workflows — two words, both capitalized. Always use the full name in any context that's public, searchable, or first-time. "Rubicon" alone only in established conversations or internal use.

Domain

- Primary: RubiconWorkflows.ca
- Forwarding: RubiconWorkflows.com (redirect to .ca)

The .ca domain signals local Canadian credibility while .com captures default typing behavior. Both are owned; .com forwards to .ca.

Email convention

firstname@rubiconworkflows.ca

Examples: attila@rubiconworkflows.ca, [yourname]@rubiconworkflows.ca

Social handles

@rubiconworkflows on all platforms (LinkedIn, Instagram, X, Threads, etc.). Same handle everywhere for consistency. Claim now even if not yet posting.

SEO consideration

Multiple unrelated companies share the “Rubicon” name. Always use “Rubicon Workflows” in page titles, meta descriptions, headers, and any searchable text. Pair with “Vancouver” and “automation” in metadata to differentiate us in search results.

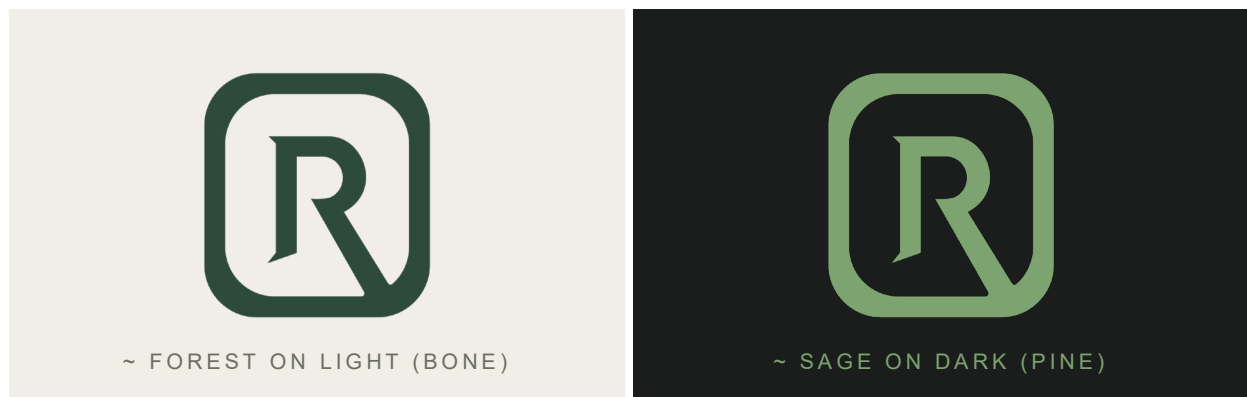
Recommended page title pattern: “Rubicon Workflows | Custom Automation for Vancouver Businesses”

8. Logo direction

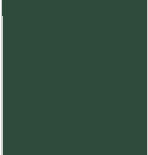
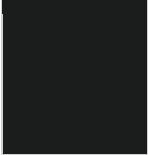
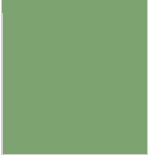
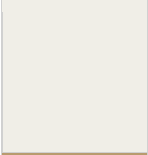
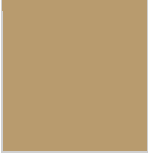
Status: The core mark is now defined — a custom “R” symbol, delivered in the five brand colorways shown below. The wordmark and full lockups are the next step; this section will expand into the complete logo system in v0.2. The brief below still stands as the reference for that work.

The mark

A custom “R” set inside a rounded-square container. The counter is cut as an angled banner and the leg drops into a single decisive downstroke — a quiet nod to crossing the line and not going back. It reads like a seal at large sizes, holds together as an app icon or favicon, and works in a single color for print and embossing. The same mark carries the whole surface system: Forest leads on light, Sage takes over on dark where Forest would disappear.



Full color set

	Mark	Color	Use
		 Forest #2E4B3C	Hero brand color and the default mark on light surfaces.
		 Pine #1A1D1B	Single-color mark for light surfaces, print, and embossing.
		 Sage #7DA371	Primary mark on dark surfaces, where Forest would disappear.
		 Bone #F0EEE7	Reversed mark for dark surfaces and watermarks.
		 Honey #B89B6E	Accent only — special badges and mono details on dark. Never the primary mark.

Clear space: keep a margin of at least half the mark's height on all sides. Minimum size: 16px for the standalone mark (favicon). Don't recolor, stretch, rotate, or add effects — use one of the five colorways above. Source files: SVG (one per colorway), with PNG exports for raster use.

What we need

A logo system that includes:

- A wordmark (Rubicon Workflows) for full-name applications
- A mark or symbol that works as a standalone (favicon, app icon, social avatar, watermark)
- Clear lockup variations: wordmark+mark, mark alone, wordmark alone
- Versions for light surface (Bone) and dark surface (Pine)

Direction

The logo should:

- Feel artistic and considered — not template-generated
- Have character without being too “designer-y” for our B2B audience
- Pair naturally with Space Grotesk + JetBrains Mono
- Work across the full surface system (light, dark, Forest)

- Scale from favicon (16px) to large applications without losing character
- Reference the brand story (the “R,” the Rubicon crossing metaphor, or both) without being too literal

We are NOT looking for:

- Pure typographic treatments with no distinguishing mark
- Generic SaaS / startup template aesthetics
- Overly literal “river crossing” imagery (bridges, water, etc.)
- Pure abstract geometric marks without character
- Mascot or illustrated figures

Concepts already explored

To save time and avoid re-exploring the same territory, here’s what we’ve already considered and moved past:

- Bracketed monogram [R]
- R with chevron / arrow
- Geometric crossed lines (“crossing the line”)
- Ascending step pattern
- Threshold arrow / piercing line
- Isometric die / cube
- Connected workflow nodes
- Flow path with right-angle turns
- Editorial masthead / stacked / slashed wordmark variants
- Custom serif R (Fraunces)
- R with botanical leaf accent
- R inside hexagonal heraldic crest
- Roman arch (architectural)
- River crossing pictorial scene
- Circular seal / medallion with R inside

Most promising directions

Of what we’ve explored, these felt closest:

- Circular seal / medallion with serif R inside (classical gravitas + modern surrounding system)
- Bold serif R as standalone mark (Fraunces or custom) paired with Space Grotesk wordmark
- Roman arch icon (architectural reference) paired with wordmark

These are reference points, not requirements. Better ideas welcome.

9. Brief for designers

If you're reading this as a designer being briefed on the project, here's the short version:

Who we are

Rubicon Workflows is a small, Vancouver-based automation consultancy. We help small-to-mid-sized businesses automate the manual parts of their operations — one step at a time, inside the tools they already use. Our clients are owner-operated companies in fields like construction, manufacturing, and strata management.

Our voice

Plainspoken, confident, educational, specific, warm but professional. We're a teaching brand, not a competitive one. Think "smart, experienced friend who happens to be an automation expert" — not "enterprise software vendor."

Our aesthetic

Technical with personality. Forest green and Sage as the brand colors, against deep near-black (Pine) and warm off-white (Bone). Space Grotesk + JetBrains Mono as the typography pairing. The brand leans dark on marketing surfaces and light on documents. Honey is a small accent color used sparingly.

What we need from the logo

A logo system (wordmark + mark) that has artistic character but stays appropriate for B2B clients. Should work in light and dark contexts, pair with our typography, and scale from favicon to print. The strongest direction we've explored is some form of distinctive "R" mark — either typographic, architectural, or seal-like — that pairs with a Space Grotesk wordmark for full lockups.

What we don't want

Generic SaaS aesthetics, too-literal Rubicon imagery (bridges, water), pure abstract geometry without character, or anything that looks like it came from a template.

Practical constraints

- Must work in both Forest (#2E4B3C) on light and Sage (#7DA371) on dark
- Must be legible at 16px (favicon)
- Must work in single-color (black on white, white on black) for print/embossing
- Final deliverables: SVG, PNG (multiple sizes), and source file

End of Brand Guidelines v0.1

Questions or to discuss further: contact us via the website (when live) or directly.